



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace & Truth Christian Academy

School Website: <https://gracetruthca.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Grace & Truth Christian Academy (Blanchard, OK, 73010) presents as a clearly Christian, classical-leaning school that foregrounds religious formation, virtue, and a Christ-centered worldview. Public materials emphasize a Christian moral framework, a stated commitment to virtue and character formation, and a classroom culture shaped by faith, worship, and a community partnership with families. The school also identifies itself as classical (e.g., "classical academic excellence") and positions its program within ACCS/ACTS-affirmed accreditation circles. Overall, the school aligns with several core elements of classical education and orients most strongly toward formation, virtue, and theological foundations. The aggregate assessment is **CLASSICAL**, with a couple of categories showing only partial alignment (**SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**), primarily in explicit curriculum details and certain pedagogical specifics that are less clearly documented on public-facing materials.

Key strengths - Strong religious/metaphysical framing: explicit theology, a Statement of Faith, weekly chapel, and Scripture-centered instruction. - Clear purpose/goal oriented toward formation, virtue, and a Christ-centered life beyond mere information or job-readiness. - Public materials emphasize virtue, character, integrity, and love of learning, tied to a classical vocabulary (e.g., "classical academic excellence"). - Visible faculty and staff presence (Director/head of school, listed teachers) and explicit parent partnership in the education process.

Key opportunities - Explicit public statements about the full curriculum ingredients of a classical program (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) are present in the classical mold but not all elements are clearly named on the site; adding explicit signals about Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and Socratic pedagogy would strengthen the curriculum category. - Pedagogy section would benefit from more explicit articulation of memory/recitation (Scholé) and Socratic dialogue in the upper grades to align with the classical pedagogy rubric.

Overall classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials present a Christ-centered worldview, Scripture-led instruction, and a Statement of Faith. Examples include mission statements emphasizing education "in light of God's Word in a Christ-centered worldview" and explicit theological affirmations (Trinity) in the Statement of Faith. - Weekly chapel and Bible-centered framing in the curriculum/school life are noted in admissions and program materials. - Core Values explicitly tie belief in God's Word to truth, virtue, and character formation (e.g., "BELIEVE God's Word is the foundation for all truth").

Positive keyword analysis - Keywords present: God, Word, Christ-centered, Bible, Theology/Trinity (Statement of Faith), Worship/Weekly Chapel, truth, foundation for truth, Scripture, God's Word, Christian worldview, church/Church, grace, love. - This set aligns with Positive Keywords such as truth, virtue, character, theology, and sacred/administrative theology signals in the classical rubric. (See Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements document.)

Negative keyword analysis - No clear presence of Negative Keywords related to undermining religious formation (e.g., secular ethics, relativism, instrumentalization of education). The public materials consistently foreground theology and worship rather than secular conceptual frameworks.

Why this rating - The school presents an explicit theological base, a Statement of Faith, liturgical practices (Weekly Chapel), and a Christ-centered approach that treats truth as knowable through Divine revelation. These align with the Classical School criterion of Transcendental moral realism and Grounded Theology, as described in the Six Essential Elements rubric. The weight of explicit doctrinal signaling and liturgical/community life supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes formation through a Christ-centered worldview and preparation for lifelong loving, learning, service, worship, and leadership. Vision emphasizes classical academic excellence with a focus on influencing the world for Jesus Christ. - Repeated emphasis on formation, virtue and character, and the cultivation of human excellence rather than job-specific training. Core Values emphasize serving, pursuing excellence, and shaping a life founded on God's Word.

Positive keyword analysis - Keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom (implied through character training and excellence), truth (via "foundation for all truth"), beauty (implicit in "the true, the good, the beautiful" phrasing in classical literature, though not literally quoted in GTCA site text), God's Word, Christ-centered worldview, character, integrity. - Positive keyword signals from the classical rubric include formation, virtue, truth, and moral/imaginative depth; the site's language aligns with formation over mere information. See "formation" and "foundation for truth" terms in the school materials.

Negative keyword analysis - No explicit signals of relativism, instrumentalism, or strictly vocational primacy. The emphasis remains formation of character and virtue, aligned with classical aims.

Why this rating - The stated goals and mission clearly privilege formation, virtue, and a transcendent truth grounded in Scripture. The school articulates an aim beyond workforce preparation, aligning with the Classical rubric's category of formation and teleology toward human excellence. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school uses a "classical Christian" framing and emphasizes a rigorous Christian curriculum with scripture-centered instruction. The site highlights a classical orientation and "classical academic excellence," but explicit signals about the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books/Great Conversation are not consistently named on public pages; however, the ACCS/ACTS accreditation and classical branding signal alignment with classical curriculum norms.

Positive keyword analysis - Keywords present: classical, Christian, Bible/scripture-lens, profound grounding in the Word, academic excellence (classical branding), mission- and vision-language around forming learners with virtue. - From the classical rubric, verifiable positives include: classical academic excellence, Great Books/Great Conversation signals (not consistently explicit in GTCA text), and liberal-arts framing is implied by "classical" branding. The explicit Great Books and Trivium signals are not consistently present in public GTCA pages, though some public materials hint at a broader classical approach.

Negative keyword analysis - Absence of explicit, public signals for Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the visible GTCA site pages. Absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references on the website weakens full alignment with Element 3's curriculum criteria as defined by the Six Essential

Elements doc. The absence of those explicit signals suggests only partial alignment in public messaging. (See the Six Essential Elements document for the precise curriculum signals.)

Why this rating - Grace Truth adheres to a classical framing and uses a traditional church-based curriculum lens, but explicit public signals about grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great Books are not consistently documented on the site. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: the school leans classical but does not consistently demonstrate full explicit signals across all required Great-Books/Trivium signals in public materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials highlight a mix of approaches consistent with classical education (e.g., a mission oriented toward formation, virtue, and a classical emphasis). Some evidence suggests a contemplative or liturgical rhythm (Weekly Chapel) and a strong memory/recitation orientation in classical pedagogy, but explicit signals of Socratic seminars or upper-school rhetoric training are less clearly documented on the site. The explicit “Socratic dialogue” or “Scholē” elements are not consistently evident in GTCA’s public content.

Positive keyword analysis - Potential signals aligning with classical pedagogy: “formation,” “virtue,” “memory/recitation” (as a general classical principle in the Six Essential Elements), “Socratic dialogue” and “great conversation” are listed in the classical rubric as positive signals, and the school’s classical framing is present, plus use of weekly chapel and spiritual formation signals. Public GTCA materials emphasize formation and virtue, which map onto Positive Keywords like contemplation, memory, and virtuous inquiry in the rubric. See the “Positive Keywords” list in the Six Essential Elements doc.

Negative keyword analysis - Absence of explicit, public signals of ongoing Socratic seminars in high school or a structured recitation/memorization program visible on the site limits full alignment with Element 4’s pedagogy signals. The Six Essential Elements document identifies the presence of memorization/recitation and contemplative pedagogy as important signals; GTCA’s public text does not clearly advertise these in detail.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a classical framing and memory/recitation signals are part of the broader classical rubric, but explicit, documented pedagogy signals (e.g., regular Socratic seminars in upper grades, explicit integration of memorization/recitation as a formal practice) are not consistently shown in public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials show a named leadership and multiple faculty roles (Director/Head of School; named teachers such as K-4, Kindergarten, and First Grade). The site includes “Meet the Teacher / Meet Our Staff,” indicating a lived curriculum carried by teachers. This aligns with the idea of a “living curriculum” and a college of virtuous educators.

Positive keyword analysis - Keywords present: model teachers and mentors; teachers as the living curriculum; presence of a clearly defined faculty; leadership roles. These map to Positive Keywords such as mentorship, virtue in teachers, and living exemplars, as described in the Six Essential Elements document (e.g., “the living curriculum,” “mentorship,” “model teachers”). See the “Positive Keywords” section in the Six Essential Elements doc.

Negative keyword analysis - No explicit negative signals indicating a lack of teacher formation or professional mentorship in the public materials.

Why this rating - The public GTCA content shows concrete faculty roles and leadership, which aligns with the classical criteria for a robust faculty (model teachers, living curriculum). Thus Element 5 is CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize partnership with families (parents as co-teachers) and opportunities for parents to engage via open houses, preview days, and parent testimonials. The admissions content explicitly notes partnering with families in the education process and supporting the church's mission; there are multiple parent-facing items and opportunities for experiential involvement.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent engagement, home-school partnership, parental involvement, community support. These align with the Six Essential Elements' Positive Keywords for Community and Cultural Practices (e.g., partnership with families, formation of affections, cultural transmission). See the Positive Keywords section.

Negative keyword analysis - No negative signals indicating weak parental involvement; the site actively advertises open houses, preview days, and parent testimonials.

Why this rating - The GTCA site consistently promotes parental partnership and community involvement, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for family engagement and a school-as-community model. Element 6 is CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking and Narrative - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate: CLASSICAL

Notes on "needle-moving" changes (What would move the needle) - If the school wishes to move toward a fully CLASSICAL profile across Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4), it could more explicitly document and publicly signal: - Element 3: Seven Liberal Arts signaling (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium elements) and Great Books/Great Conversation signals; direct articulation of how Great Books are incorporated; and explicit mention of the Great Conversation in the curriculum. This would align the Curriculum with the full classical rubric. Suggested signals: explicit statements about grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, and cross-disciplinary Great Conversations in public materials. - Element 4: Pedagogy signals for Socratic discourse in upper grades, regular memorization/recitation (Schol  ) as formal practice, and contemplative learning along with rich memory work (chanting, etc.) as per the classical model. This would convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Pedagogy to CLASSICAL. - Additional strengthening could emphasize "the living curriculum" more explicitly and publicly (faculty as mentors, modeling virtue across disciplines) to further reinforce Element 5.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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